

Independent English (B1 Intermediate)

A 13-week, 26-class English course for adults who can handle everyday situations and want to go further. Twice a week for 90 minutes, you learn to tell detailed stories, give and defend your opinions, report what people said, and deal with real situations at work: discussions, complaints, and job interviews. Between classes, the free online lessons (with audio) are your homework.

LEVEL

**CEFR B1 ·
Intermediate**

DURATION

**13 weeks · 26
classes**

EACH CLASS

**90 minutes · 2 ×
week**

CONTENT

**8 modules · 24
lessons**

CLASS SCHEDULE

Two classes a week, 90 minutes each. Every class has **one lesson** from the online course, except the two assessment classes. Lessons 4.3 and 8.3 are **review projects**: a story-and-opinion task at the halfway point, and a short presentation with a panel discussion at the end. ✓ = the can-do goal for that class.

WEEK 1**Time & Experience**

Module 1: choosing between the present perfect and the past simple, and talking about ongoing activities.

C1

1.1

Present Perfect vs Past Simple

connected to now vs finished time · for / since · already, yet, just, still

✓ I can choose the right tense to talk about my experiences.

C2

1.2

Present Perfect Continuous

have / has been + -ing · How long...? · simple vs continuous · stative verbs

✓ I can say how long I've been doing something.

WEEK 2**Past Habits & Real Possibilities**

Modules 1–2: how life used to be, and what will happen if...

C3

1.3

Used to & Would — Past Habits

used to for habits and states · didn't use to · would for repeated actions

✓ I can describe how my life used to be different.

C4

2.1

Zero & First Conditional

facts vs likely futures · no will after if · unless · if vs when

✓ I can talk about real possibilities and their results.

WEEK 3**Imagining & Wishing**

Module 2: unreal situations, advice, and wishes about the present.

C5

2.2

Second Conditional — Imagining

If + past, would + base verb · first vs second · If I were you, I'd...

✓ I can imagine situations and give friendly advice.

C6

2.3

Wish & If Only — Regrets & Wishes

wish + past · I wish I were... · wish + could · wish + would (annoyance)

✓ I can say what I wish were different.

WEEK 4**Reporting What People Say**

Module 3: passing on statements, questions, and requests.

C7

3.1

Reported Speech — Statements

tense backshift · pronoun and time changes · say vs tell

✓ I can tell someone what another person said.

C8

3.2

Reported Questions, Requests & Commands

asked where I lived · if / whether · told me (not) to...

✓ I can report questions, requests, and instructions.

WEEK 5**Connecting Ideas & the Passive**

Modules 3–4: adding detail with relative clauses, and shifting the focus with the passive.

C9

3.3

Relative Clauses

who, which, that, where, when, whose · defining vs non-defining · commas

✓ I can describe people, places, and things in detail.

C10

4.1

The Passive Voice

is / are + past participle · was / were + past participle · by + agent

✓ I can describe processes, products, and facts.

WEEK 6**Deduction & a Halfway Project**

Module 4: how sure you are, and the first review project.

C11

4.2

Modals of Deduction & Obligation

must / can't / might for deduction · have to, don't have to, mustn't, should

✓ I can make logical guesses and explain rules.

C12

4.3

Review Project — Opinions & Storytelling

giving and supporting opinions · agreeing and disagreeing politely · Modules 1–4 in a story

✓ I can tell a connected story and defend an opinion.

WEEK 7**Halfway Check & the Earlier Past**

Module 5: a friendly progress test, then the past perfect.

C13

TEST**Progress Test 1 (Modules 1–4) + Catch-Up**

~50-min written check · 7-min pair speaking · catch-up stations

✓ I know what I do well and what to practice.

C14

5.1

Past Perfect — The Earlier Past

had + past participle · which happened first? · by the time, already, never ... before

✓ I can explain what had happened before something else.

WEEK 8**Stories & the Future**

Module 5: telling a full story, and talking about plans and predictions.

C15

5.2**Narrative Tenses — Telling a Story**

past simple, continuous, and perfect together · first, suddenly, while, in the end

✓ I can tell a true story with a clear background and order.

C16

5.3**Future Forms & Future Continuous**

will, going to, present continuous · will be + -ing · when / as soon as + present

✓ I can talk about my plans, arrangements, and predictions.

WEEK 9**Precision: Articles & Verb Patterns**

Module 6: the small words and patterns that make English sound natural.

C17

6.1**Articles — a/an, the & Zero Article**

first mention vs known · talking in general · go to bed, by bus, play the piano

✓ I can use a, an, and the correctly when I describe a place.

C18

6.2**Gerunds & Infinitives**

enjoy -ing · decide to · tell someone to · good at -ing · stop, remember, forget, try

✓ I can talk about my habits, plans, and preferences.

WEEK 10**How Much & Having Your Say**

Modules 6–7: words of degree and quantity, then the language of discussion.

C19

6.3**Degree & Quantity**

too / enough · so / such ... that · (a) few, (a) little · all / most / some / none of

✓ I can review a movie, meal, or place with precision.

C20

7.1**Agreeing, Disagreeing & Discussion**

opinion phrases · agreeing · disagreeing politely · asking and softening

✓ I can take part in a discussion and disagree politely.

WEEK 11**Complaints & Interviews**

Module 7: getting problems fixed, and talking about your work.

C21

7.2**Complaints & Getting Things Fixed**

describing a problem · polite openers · Would it be possible to...? · responding as staff

✓ **I can make a polite complaint and handle one.**

C22

7.3**Work & Interviews — Describing Your Experience**

I'm responsible for... · I have experience in... · strengths with examples · interview questions

✓ **I can describe my experience and answer interview questions.**

WEEK 12**Natural Conversation**

Module 8: keeping a conversation going, and everyday phrasal verbs.

C23

8.1**Question Tags & Keeping a Conversation Going**

isn't it? / don't you? · aren't I?, shall we? · falling vs rising · Did you? Really?

✓ **I can keep a friendly conversation going.**

C24

8.2**Phrasal Verbs — A Practical Toolkit**

literal vs idiomatic · separable vs inseparable · turn it off, not turn off it

✓ **I can use common phrasal verbs about daily life, travel, and problems.**

WEEK 13**Bringing It Together**

Module 8: the capstone presentation, the final test, and a celebration.

C25

8.3**Review Project — Presentation & Panel Discussion**

a 1–2 minute talk with signposting · a panel discussion · listening practice

✓ **I can give a short talk and discuss it.**

C26

TEST**Final Test + Celebration**

~60-min written test · individual speaking interview · certificates

✓ **I can show what I can do in English.** 🎉

EVERY CLASS, THE SAME SHAPE

0:00	Warmer & review of the last class A speaking game that recycles last class's language
0:10	Presentation A dialogue, story, or discussion · meaning, form & pronunciation
0:30	Drill Listen and repeat: all together, then one by one
0:40	Controlled practice Workbook exercises, then check with a partner
0:55	<i>Break (5 min)</i>
1:00	Speaking Discussions, storytelling, role-plays, interviews, and presentations in pairs and groups
1:20	Feedback & “I can...” Fluency first, then kind error correction · tick the can-do checklist
1:25	Homework set-up The online lesson with  audio + one workbook page

COURSE DETAILS

■ Prerequisites

- ◆ **CEFR A2.** You can tell simple stories about the past, talk about your plans and experiences, and handle everyday situations such as shopping, travel, and the doctor's office.
- ◆ Finished **Everyday English (A2)**? You're ready. New to our program? Take the shared **placement test** first.
- ◆ Learners who are still building basic reading and writing are welcome. Every lesson has literacy-support options, and the tests have an adapted version.
- ◆ No computer needed in class. A phone helps for homework, but it isn't required.

■ What's Provided

- ◆ A **Student Workbook** for all 24 lessons, in clear B1 English (the learner keeps it)
- ◆ A **welcome handout** with class and discussion ground rules, what to bring, and QR codes to the online lessons
- ◆ For the teacher: a **Teacher's Guide** (a 90-minute plan for every class), slides, flashcards, role-play and discussion cards, listening scripts, games, and answer keys
- ◆ Free access to the companion online course: Independent English (B1), with  audio
- ◆ A free learning-tools page that shows how to translate lessons into any language

■ Assessment

- ◆ **Every class:** an “I can...” checklist and short speaking checks, with no grades
- ◆ **Class 13 • Progress Test 1** (Modules 1–4): listening, vocabulary, grammar, reading, a short opinion paragraph, and a 7-minute pair speaking task
- ◆ **Class 26 • Final Test** (all 8 modules): the same skills, a complaint email and an opinion essay, plus an individual speaking interview with a story, a short talk, a discussion, and a role-play
- ◆ Rubrics follow the CEFR B1 descriptors. Results decide the **next class**, never who gets to celebrate
- ◆ Tasks about your life can always use a “**new identity**” or an imagined story instead of real details

■ Homework & the Online Course

- ◆ After each class, do the matching **online lesson** at home: about **30 minutes**, with  Listen buttons for model sentences and dialogues
- ◆ Plus one **workbook page** to review the class
- ◆ Missed a class? The online lesson covers the same language, so you can catch up
- ◆ After the course: Confident English (B2) continues the same free ladder, from A1 all the way to C2

What You'll Be Able to Do

By the end of the course, learners reach **CEFR B1** and can use English independently, at work and in daily life:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ✓ Tell a detailed story with the right past tenses, in a clear order | ✓ Talk about experiences, and how long you have been doing things |
| ✓ Describe how life used to be, and how it has changed | ✓ Talk about real and imaginary situations, and what you wish were different |
| ✓ Report what other people said, asked, and told you to do | ✓ Describe people, places, processes, and facts in detail |
| ✓ Give, support, and defend an opinion, and disagree politely | ✓ Make a complaint that gets results, and handle one politely |
| ✓ Describe your work experience and answer job-interview questions | ✓ Give a short, well-organized presentation and take part in a discussion |

Companion course, free online: rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1 · Free translation & learning tools: rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html

Ray de la Paz

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v1.0 · 13 weeks · 26 classes · 39 instructional hours